DIASPORA-YOUTH AGRIBUSINESS MATCHMAKING GUIDELINES

A practical guide for connecting Ugandan youth in agribusiness with the diaspora

Version 2 | July 2025

TABLE OF CONTENT

Table of Content	2
About the Uganda Diaspora in Agribusiness Network (UDAN)	3
Introduction to the UDAN's Diaspora-Youth Agribusiness Match Making Programme	4
Specifically, the Match Making Programme aims to	4
The Match Making Journey	5
Expression of Interest (EOI): Annual call for agriprenuers' participation	5
Screening of Agriprenuer Applicants	6
Agriprenuer Enterprise development	6
Annual Call for Expression of Interest (EOI): Diaspora Participation	7
Matching of agriprenuers to diaspora	7
Follow up activities	7

ABOUT THE UGANDA DIASPORA IN AGRIBUSINESS NETWORK (UDAN)

The Uganda Diaspora in Agribusiness Network ("UDAN") is a independent member based Ugandan diaspora agribusiness network established with support of the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO) and formally registered with the Uganda Registration Services Bureau in 2022.

UDAN promotes Ugandan diaspora financial and non-financial contributions to the Uganda's agrifood sector. By establishing a global network of country level UDAN chapters, UDAN champions the cause of agrifood sector development in Uganda by encouraging Ugandans abroad to engage in the opportunity that the agrifood sector presents through a commercial return while giving back to their home country.

Uganda's heavy reliance on agriculture, with over 70% of its population depending on it for livelihoods, places it among the most climate-vulnerable countries. UDAN

UDAN acts as a bridge between Ugandan diaspora and migration and agricultural and rural stakeholder in Uganda.

Specifically, its mandate through five pillars namely:

Agrifood Policy:

and UDAN contribute to shaping agri food sector policy and act as a bridge between diaspora and Ugandan migration and agricultural and rural stakeholders to facilitate opportunities for diaspora-inclusive dialogue around investments and employment opportunities in agri-food systems

Promotion of diaspora investments into Uganda's Agrifood sector: UDAN facilitates the transfer of diaspora investments into the Ugandan agrifood sector through the diaspora-youth matchmaking programme, the online marketplace hosted on the UDAN website, UDAN talk series, and investment conferences, organized in partnership with FAO, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Ministry of Agriculture Animal Industry and Fisheries as well as various government agencies aligned with UDAN's mandate.

Capacity development: UDAN facilitates information dissemination to diaspora agriprenuers about Uganda's agrifood sector, including through the organization of dialogues, workshops and conferences.

UDAN conducts regular online learning series that draw from topical subjects in the agri food sector for the benefit of its members with the expectation of converting the information into tangible opportunities for both diasporans and various sector actors including youth agripreneurs.

UDAN also organises an annual flagship conference under different thematic areas of member interest to show case diaspora in agribusiness contributions to the agrifood sector. An example of which is the 2025 conference that will focus on contributing to achieving national climate adaptation and mitigation goals. The conference brings together Ugandan Government institutions, private sector, youth agripreneurs and diaspora agripreneurs from Uganda and across the world including the rest of Africa, Europe, Canada, Japan, United Arab Emirates, United Kingdom, and United States of America.

Promotion of Agrifood leverages the expertise, knowledge, and experience of the diaspora to support agrifood technologies in the various agricultural value chains and provide peer-to-peer support to Ugandan youth agripreneurs on how to embrace technology to improve production and productivity.

Access to diaspora markets: UDAN promotes the access to regional and global markets.

INTRODUCTION TO THE UDAN'S DIASPORA-YOUTH AGRIBUSINESS MATCH MAKING PROGRAMME

Ugandan agribusinesses face significant challenges, including limited access to finance, inadequate technology, low production capacity, and restricted market access. Meanwhile, the Ugandan diaspora remains a largely untapped resource with immense potential to contribute to the growth of the agri-food sector and the fight against climate change. Many diaspora members who are willing to support their communities back home often lack the necessary information and guidance on where to channel their support, what areas are most impactful, how to engage effectively, and which local actors to collaborate with. Through investments, technical expertise, and market linkages, the diaspora can play a pivotal role in building climate-resilient agricultural communities, fostering sustainable development.

UDAN's flagship Diaspora-Youth agribusiness matchmaking programme is a joint initiative between the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) and Uganda Diaspora Agribusiness Network (UDAN), that aims to connect and pair prescreened Ugandan youth-led agribusinesses with Uganda's diaspora agripreneurs and investors to facilitate the transfer of diaspora investments, technology, and skills into youth-led agribusinesses as well as to promote exportation of Ugandan agro foods product to diaspora's markets.

To deliver this programme, UDAN collaborates with FAO, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA), Ministry of Agriculture, Animal Industry and Fisheries (MAAIF), Uganda Investment Authority (UIA), Uganda Free Zones and Export Promotions Authority (UFZEPA), among others. Importantly, UDAN is also partnering with the Young Farmers Champions Network (YOFCHAN) to promote the programme and access a pipeline of youth agriprenuers who are ready to be matched with the diaspora for mutual benefit.

The match making programme adopts a systematic approach to bridge the gap between the demand from diaspora markets and the supply of agricultural produce from Ugandan producers.

SPECIFICALLY, THE MATCH MAKING PROGRAMME AIMS TO

- Increase market access for Ugandan agricultural products to diaspora markets
- Grow the production and enterprise capacity of youth agriprenuers to meet the export needs of the diaspora markets
- Attract diaspora investments into Ugandan agrifood businesses to increase agri production and productivity
- Support export readiness of agripreneurs by addressing key gaps, including certification, packaging, and linkages to logistics providers, among others.
- Promote resilience and sustainability by integrating climate-smart and adaptive practices into agro-enterprise operations.
- Facilitate access to financing for agro producers to enable them to meet market demand.

THE MATCH MAKING JOURNEY

The match making journey will follow the path explained below -

- Expression of Interest (EOI): Annual call for agriprenuers' participation
- Screening of Agriprenuer Applicants
- Agriprenuer Enterprise development
- Annual Call for Expression of Interest (EOI): Diaspora Participation
- Matching of agriprenuers to diaspora
- Follow up activities

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI): ANNUAL CALL FOR AGRIPRENUERS' PARTICIPATION

An annual call for expression of interest is published and disseminated by UDAN via different platforms, including the UDAN website and UDAN social media platforms, in collaboration with the Young Farmers Champions Network (YOFCHAN), among others.

The call aims to identify youth agriprenuers interested in being matched with Ugandans in the diaspora to access markets, investment, technology and knowledge.

- The EOI seeks to collect the following data about the agribusiness-
- Names of agriprenuer
- Name of agribusiness
- Registration status
- Location
- Memberships/affiliations
- Business history and model including products and financial performance
- Agricultural sub-sector and value chain segment
- Markets, Customers and Partnerships
- Potential for regional and global exports
- Business processes, organizational capacity challenges
- Interest/needs
- The EOI information is collected and maintained by UDAN as part of the programme application process.
- Following the data collection, UDAN systematizes all the information into a database. The output of this stage is a long list of annual programme applicants.

SCREENING OF AGRIPRENUER APPLICANTS

An evaluation of the applicants will be carried out based on the EOI criteria. Applicants who meet the eligibility criteria will be shortlisted for the year's matching programme.

The number of applicants shortlisted will be determined annually based on resources availability to conduct a successful programme.

Selected finalists will be notified via email and phone calls with a copy of the year's match making programme.

UDAN will profile all interested youth agripreneurs and publish their profiles for the diaspora to connect with their needs

The output of this stage is a shortlist of agriprenuers/enterprises for the year's match making programme.

AGRIPRENUER ENTERPRISE DEVELOPMENT

Selected finalists will go through a structured enterprise development process that includes an enterprise diagnostic, investor readiness preparation, capacity building and mentorship.

Specifically, this stage will include the following steps:

- Enterprise diagnostics
- Issuance of a standard enterprise diagnostic template to the participating enterprises. Key areas to consider include business strategy or model, markets, customers, revenue model, financial health, operational efficiency, customer satisfaction, employee performance, risk management, and technology capabilities
- In addition, the template shall test the enterprise readiness for climate resilience and adaptation.
- Enterprise Improvement Plan Preparation and Sign off
- Co-creation of a business improvement plan for the enterprise
- Sign off of the plans the entrepreneurs
- Agriprenuers will be guided through goal setting and problem solving, networking, strategy and business planning.
- Specific sessions on export promotion will be designed into this segment
- Specific sessions on climate resilience and adaptation shall be designed into this segment
- Preparation of Pitch Decks for Investor or Partner Engagement
- Issuance of a business pitch deck template to entrepreneurs
- Guidance on preparation of pitch decks
- Pitch deck presentation training through organised sessions
- Selection of top-rated business models to be presented at annual UDAN conferences
- Key outputs of this stage will include -
- Enterprise diagnostic reports
- Enterprise improvement plans
- Enterprise pitch decks

ANNUAL CALL FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI): DIASPORA PARTICIPATION

UDAN will issue an annual Call for Expressions of Interest addressed to the Ugandan Diaspora. The call will be disseminated through UDAN channels, other diaspora organizations platforms and the Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

- The number of applicants shortlisted will be determined annually based on resources availability to conduct a successful programme.
- Selected finalists will be notified via email and phone calls with a copy of the year's match making programme.

UDAN will profile all interested diaspora and publish their profiles for the youth agriprenuers to connect with their needs.

- The output of this stage is a the year's match making programme.

MATCHING OF AGRIPRENUERS TO DIASPORA

Diaspora and youth connections categorized under the different needs i.e. investments, knowledge, technology, market and the nexus of the foregoing elements.

These projects will be then allocated to project staff for active management to ensure conversion.

- Active project management shall include the following
- Facilitate signing of non-disclosure agreements (NDAs)

Supporting the required diaspora due diligence on the agribusinesses.

- Facilitate signing of partnership agreements
- Preparation and signing off project workplans to track progress
- Facilitating connections to required government agencies and other enabling entities
- Documenting milestones

FOLLOW UP ACTIVITIES

- Every annual match making cohort shall receive 12 months follow up window. The following activities will be prioritised at this stage
- Agriprenuers and diaspora will be assessed on the outcomes from the set individual project goals and objectives.
- Preparation of individual project case studies
- Annual match making report to document progress made in the year including the number of participant diaspora and agriprenuers, number of NDAs and partnership agreements
- Key outputs of this stage will include -
- NDA templates
- Partnership Agreement templates
- Annual match making report/Story Book
- Publication of success stories